and more land is required for crops—much of which are used to feed cattle, pigs, and sheep for slaughter.

In 2020, a report published by an international team of academics in the journal *Nature* addressed these questions. It describes how the downward curve of biodiversity can be halted and reversed only through an integrated strategy involving both land management and agricultural change. The report calls for the designation of protected areas to be expanded quickly, to 40 percent of Earth's land area, and for the restoration of degraded land, which would amount to a further 8 percent. This, the authors claim, would reduce the rate of decline in biodiversity by 2050.

Such measures could, however, put pressure on global agriculture, leading to more expensive food and more hungry people. To avoid this and reverse the fall in biodiversity, the report advocates reducing the massive wastage of food that occurs during transport and processing, and for people to adopt more sustainable (less meat-heavy) diets.